

Workplace Safety

Workplace safety refers to providing a healthy and safe environment for workers. It is the primary responsibility of the organization. This can be called Workplace Health and Safety (WHS) or Occupational Health and Safety (OH&S). Several acts and regulations ensure workplace safety. In Australia, these are often state—and territory-based.

For Vitoria, the governing bodies are:

- Act: **Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004** ➞ <https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/in-force/acts/occupational-health-and-safety-act-2004/044>
- Regulation: **Occupational Health and Safety Regulations 2017** ➞ <https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/in-force/statutory-rules/occupational-health-and-safety-regulations-2017/014>
- Codes: **Victoria Compliance Codes and Codes of practice** ➞ <https://www.worksafe.vic.gov.au/laws-and-regulations>
- Regulator: **Work Safe Victoria** ➞ <https://www.worksafe.vic.gov.au/>

Organizations ensure a healthy and safe work environment for the workers and train them on their responsibilities to carry on their duties in a healthy and safe manner. The primary responsibilities of the workers in this regard are:

- Take care of yourself
- Do not hurt others
- Know OH&S policies and regulations
- Follow OH&S instructions

Failing to ensure a healthy and safe workplace can lead to the following for IT workers...

- Musculoskeletal disorders - Shoulder pain!!
- Eye strain
- Work-life balance - practice a good routine from the beginning
- Anxiety
- Stress

Some of the things you should pay special attention to...

- The desk and the chair - this is very important, you are going to spend a lot of time with these
- Moving from meeting to meeting or task to task - make sure enough time is planned for the transitions
- Taking breaks (micro- break, can you program it?) - This is a must, especially for your eyes and mind
- Keep everyone informed - helpful to avoid extra stress from peoples' reactions



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COS40006 - Week 12 Webinar - Workplace Safety

